



arcade ■ digit diary

Wild things

From red Ferraris to fire brigades, all in a day's work

A fast expanding group of fanatics calling themselves 'The Techies' have found their haven in the small city of Singapore. With its Sim Lim Square and Funan Centre filled with every conceivable kind of



Singapore has many forms of 'hardware'

gadget, the island of Singapore is enveloped in a Digital Droolmaal fog all year round. So when our Head of Writers, Marco, found out that he had to go on a three-day press visit to the Lion City, he quickly made a shopping list of all the

toys he wanted to bring back. But what he didn't know was that there are some things you just can't fit into a backpack.

The hotel where Marco was staying owned a bevy of beautiful cars—everything from a Mercedes S320 to a Jaguar XJ12 to a couple of BMW 7-series—enough to give any car enthusiast like Marco a cardiac arrest. But what really stopped the blood in his veins was the sleek Ferrari 360 Modena—Sachin's car! When he got his breath back, he crept up to the car, half expecting the proximity alarm to go off. But the feline predator didn't attack, so he quickly whipped out his camera and took pictures of it from every conceivable angle—even managing to get an under-the-hood shot! As he finally got out of his shutter happy mode, he let out a huge sigh and wondered how it felt to be Sachin.

Snakes at four

Our Nerul office had a surprise visit this month from one of our animal friends. During the lunch hour when everyone was herding down towards the canteen, a six-foot long grass snake slipped out from the dispatch section in the basement and

made its way to the cafeteria. Now like Mother Nature, but a snake is purely vegetarian canteen was just bit unnerving. So John, our cafeteria tractor, swiftly called the fire br



Say Cheese! (watch that tail please!)

while the rest of our colleagues sh out for Jiten, our in-house photogra Never one to miss an opportunity f perfect picture, Jiten clicked away firemen caught the unwanted visit secured him into a bag.

Will the animal activists please that we had bhelpuri for tea that M and it contained no non-vegetarian tent, at least none that we knew of

Looking Within!

Ask anyone for a first impression of the people at Jasubhai Digital Media, and you will invariably hear comments like 'bunch of youngsters', 'technology zealots', even 'rogues'. But sometimes, even as we are on a do or die mission to catch those ever-elusive deadlines, deep existential questions occur to some of us. One such question occurred to Viridi, a coordinator with our Content Services team.

Before you think this is a plot for a Hindi potboiler, lets recap a bit. Louis, head of our magazines & Web sites division, and Anurag, the brand manager of ZDNetIndia, were having an informal discussion on different types

of personalities and how they affect a team. Viridi was a mostly silent observer and found the conversation extremely interesting. But a voice whispered deep inside him: "What type am I?" Always the one to convert thought to action, Viridi discussed this with others in the office and seeing that quite a few were interested in knowing more, urged Louis and Anurag to hold a formal training session that would help people understand their strengths and weaknesses and use them to the advantage of the team. Thus 14 volunteers picked a Saturday for the personality development camp. Everybody arrived at 9 am sharp for the daylong workshop, even

though it was the weekend. While there a liberal dose of *gyaan*, there were some prising revelations too. One of the exercises consisted of an exhaustive questionnaire (along the lines of the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator). Almost everybody stated they were of the 'seriously intellectual' type (€ those who rarely let go an opportunity to monkey around)! All save Viridi, who me entered that he was the 'laid-back' kind.

That was it. Now when anything g awry, there's always Viridi to put the bl on. Ask Viridi and he'll tell you that's th last time he'll ever walk the path to self discovery!